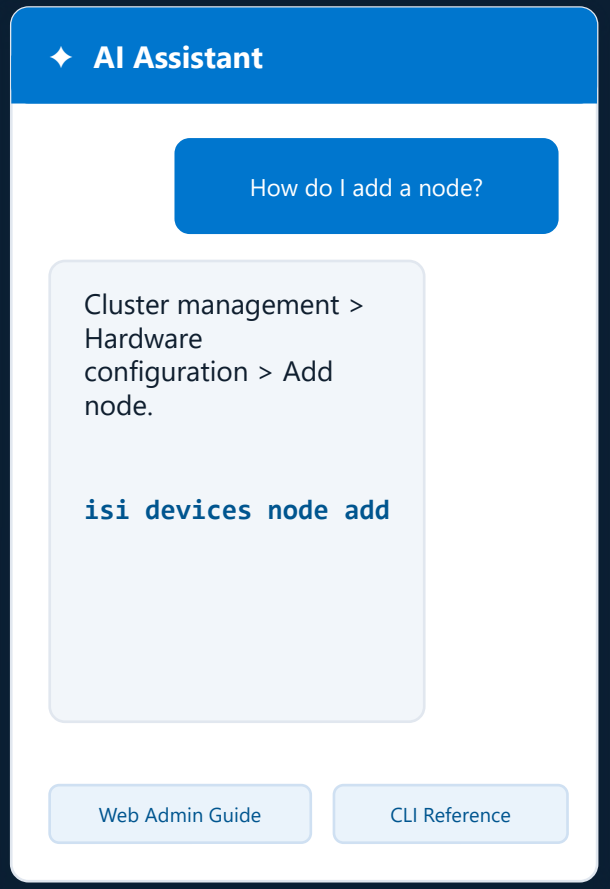
PRODUCT PROPOSAL · DELL POWERSCALE · MANAGEMENT REVIEW

An expert in the console, at 2 a.m.

A documentation-grounded admin assistant embedded in the OneFS WebUI and InsightIQ — running entirely on the customer's cluster.



Prototype built & demonstrated · 100% local · grounded in official OneFS documentation · nothing leaves the cluster

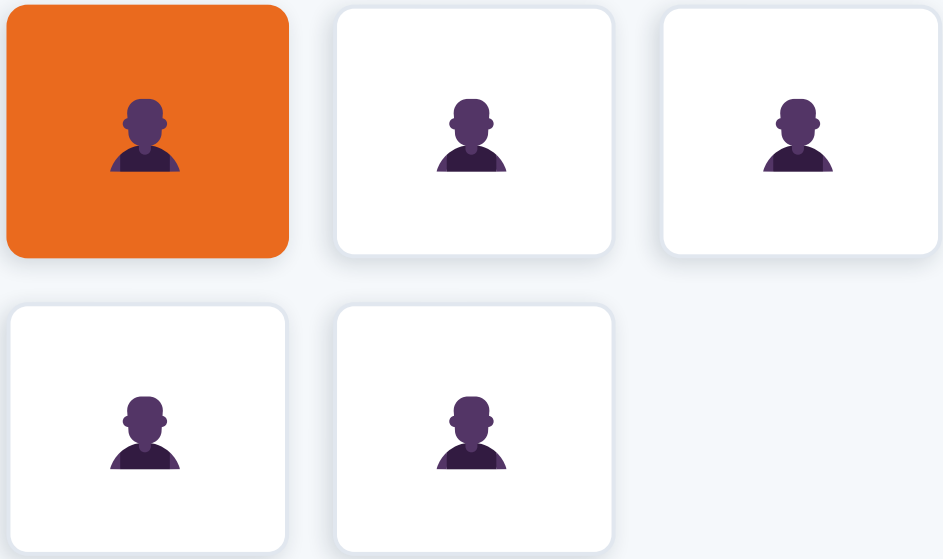
THE PROBLEM

1 in 5 support cases is an admin asking a question the docs already answer.

~20%

of support contacts are “how do I…” administration questions — not product defects.

Honest caveat. This is a working internal estimate. Step one before build is validating it against our support-ticket taxonomy.



1 in 5 = an admin question

WHO FEELS IT

Today that admin waits hours — or reads a 900-page PDF.

The storage admin, mid-change, at 2 a.m. Something is unclear and the maintenance clock is running.

Option A — open a case

Answer comes back in hours, sometimes days. The change stalls, or the admin guesses.

→ **Slow, and a cost Dell pays to answer.**

Option B — search the manuals

Dozens of guides, hundreds of pages each. The answer exists — finding it is the needle in the haystack.

→ **The answer already exists. It's just buried.**

Either path: downtime risk, frustration, and a support case for something already documented.

THE CONCEPT

Put the expert where the admin already works.

OneFS WebUI

Day-to-day administration

Answers OneFS admin & configuration questions right inside the management console the admin already has open.

InsightIQ

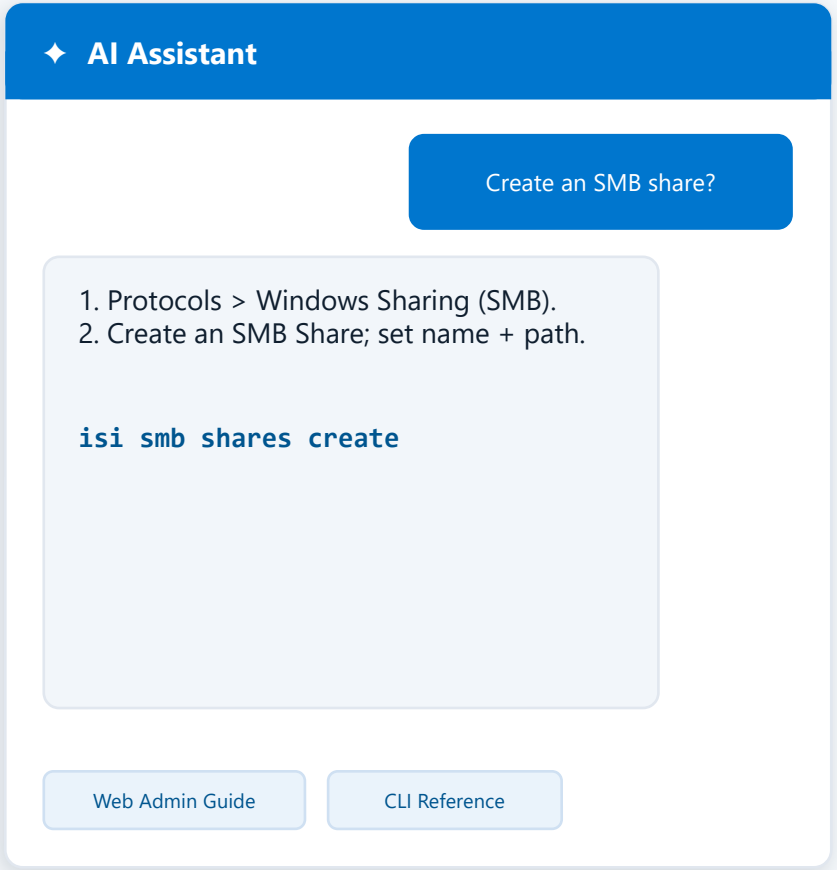
Monitoring & performance

Answers cluster, performance and alert questions where admins watch the fleet — and explains what an alert means.

One engine. Two surfaces. Same grounded, cited answers.

PROTOTYPE 1 · ONEFS WEBUI

Answers with cited sources and copy-ready commands.



1. **Grounded Q&A with citations**

   Every answer points back to the official OneFS guide it came from.

2. **Copy-ready CLI**

   isi commands render as one-click copy blocks — no re-typing.

3. **Click-to-navigate**

   Answers link straight to the right WebUI page.

4. **Explain-this-event**

   Dashboard alerts get a plain-English explanation on click.

5. **Context-aware**

   Knows which page the admin is on and tailors suggestions.

PROTOTYPE 2 · INSIGHTIQ

Adds performance answers and “explain this alert.”

1. **Everything the WebUI assistant does**

   Same grounded engine, same citations — on the InsightIQ console.

2. **Performance answers**

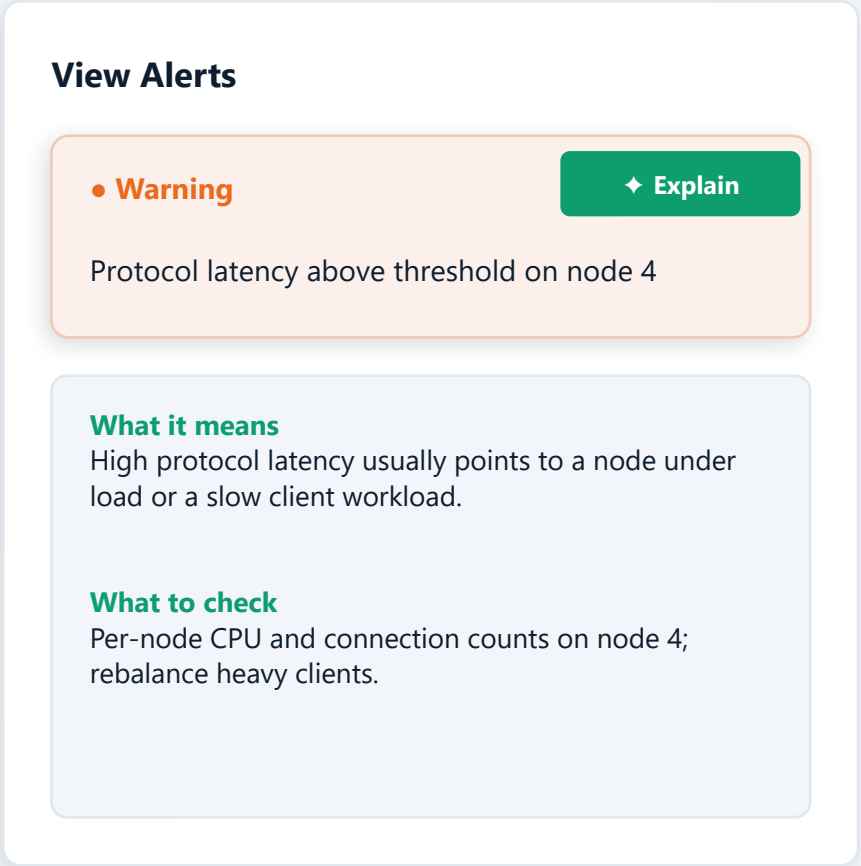
   “Which node is busiest?”, throughput, latency — read from the reports.

3. **Explain this alert**

   Plain-English cause and fix, grounded in the OneFS Event Reference.

4. **Widest scope**

   Spans OneFS admin + cluster & performance knowledge in one place.



WHAT THE PROTOTYPE PROVES

The hard part is real: grounded answers from Dell's own documentation.

REAL — and it's the product

- ✓ The answer engine — grounded retrieval + generation
- ✓ The full OneFS documentation set as the knowledge base
- ✓ Source citations on every answer
- ✓ Both embedded assistants (WebUI + InsightIQ)
- ✓ 100% local execution — no cloud

MOCKED — and only cosmetic

- ○ The console UI — faithful visual replicas
- ○ The dashboard's sample cluster numbers
- ○ The InsightIQ report figures

What's mocked is cosmetic. What's real is the engine — and the engine is the product.

HOW IT WORKS

Grounded retrieval — it answers only from Dell's docs, so a small model is enough.

1 Admin asks

a question in the console

→

2 Retrieve

top passages from this version's official docs

→

3 Summarize

a small on-cluster model, using only those passages

→

4 Cited answer

returned in the console, with sources

Only from the docs → hallucination stays low.

Summarizes, doesn't memorize → a small model fits on-cluster.

Scope wall: WebUI = OneFS docs only. InsightIQ = OneFS + cluster & performance.

TRUST & SAFETY

Grounded, version-matched, and guard-railed on destructive actions.

1 Grounded-only

Answers come from official docs with citations — never open-internet guessing.

2 Version-matched

The knowledge base ships inside each OneFS release: a 9.13 cluster gets 9.13 answers.

3 Human-in-the-loop

The assistant suggests, never executes. Confirm-before-run on any delete or modify.

4 Accuracy gate before GA

A graded test set of real admin questions, a pass bar, and SME sign-off. No shipping on vibes.

RUNNING ON THE CLUSTER

Storage stays P0 — the assistant runs in the headroom, never the workload.

1 **Small footprint**

A quantized 3B model, ~2–3 GB, loaded once. Retrieval lets us stay small.

2 **Resource-capped**

Hard CPU/RAM ceilings. Cache and client I/O always win; throttled first under load.

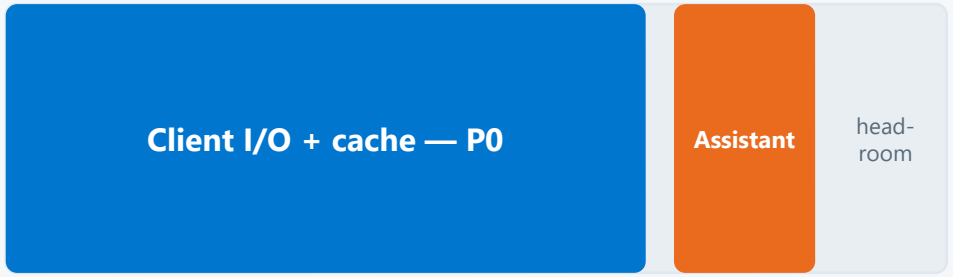
3 **Bursty, not sustained**

Works only during a question — seconds, not a 24/7 background daemon.

4 **Off-box option**

Heavy InsightIQ analysis can run on the InsightIQ VM, off the storage node.

One node's resources

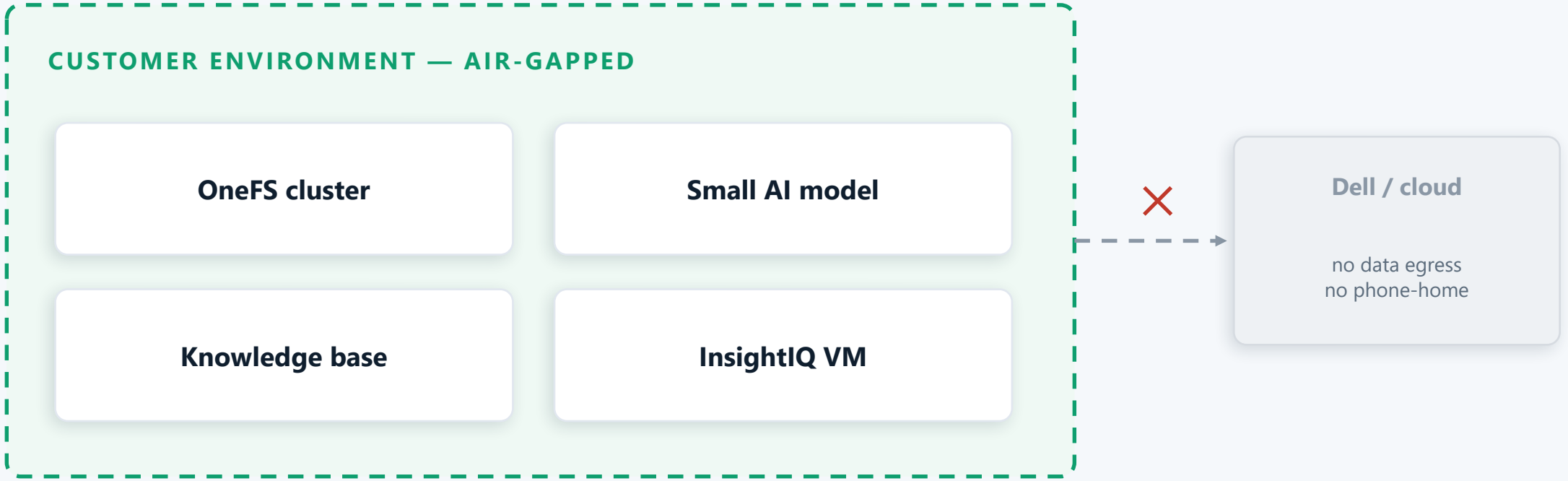


↑ *capped by a resource governor — the assistant can never starve storage.*

Phase-0 gate. Prove client P99 latency & throughput stay within ~2% with it active — or we ship off-box first.

DATA & SECURITY

100% on the customer's cluster. Nothing leaves. Nothing calls home.



Model & knowledge base ship in the release package — no download. **Cluster data and telemetry never leave the environment.**

This is what lets federal, healthcare, and security-first enterprises say yes.

THE PAYOFF

Deflect half of admin-question cases → ~10% fewer cases, plus faster onboarding.

~20% admin-question cases × **~50%** self-resolved

≈ 10% fewer support cases *(target — validated in Phase 0)*

Faster onboarding

New admins ramp faster — the console teaches itself instead of the manual.

How we'll prove it — not just claim it

- Instrument assistant-resolved vs. escalated
- Track time-to-answer
- Compare case-rate: enabled clusters vs. control

WHERE IT FITS · THE ASK

One platform: strengthen InsightIQ 6.3 today, OneFS tomorrow.

The same engine can enhance the existing InsightIQ 6.3 assistant — event guide, explain-alerts, admin Q&A. Build once, not a competing effort.

Phase 0

Prove the SLA gate + validate the 1-in-5 case number.

→

Phase 1

Ship the InsightIQ assistant off-box — lowest risk. Docs + explain-alert.

→

Phase 2

On-cluster WebUI assistant for F/H nodes, resource-governed.

→

Phase 3

Live telemetry: “why is my cluster slow right now.”

The ask: greenlight Phase 0 — prove the storage-SLA gate and validate the case number, before we invest further.